

Castles: Form and Function c.1000–1750 (J410/12 and J410/13)

OCR has specified a set site for this element of the course. Kenilworth Castle has been selected as this site for assessment from 2019 onwards, in conjunction with English Heritage.



ENGLISH
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The essence of this study is for learners to practise and develop their ability to use evidence effectively, specifically Kenilworth Castle. In general terms, castles usually perform a range of functions across their history. For example Kenilworth was used as a:

- military installation for defence
- military installation to maintain power over the population
- site used by rulers and/or rebels in times of civil war, rebellion or protest
- residence for elites which combined comfort with display and possibly intimidation
- political and administrative centre with roles such as collecting taxes, administering justice or a prison.

The aim of this study is that learners should be able to explain how historians and archaeologists can use the physical fabric of Kenilworth Castle and accompanying relevant documents and other source material to understand the purpose of the site at specific points in time and also how this purpose may have changed across a particular time span.

Questions will assess learners' knowledge of aspects of the history of the castle and the lives of those who lived and worked in it. Questions will also assess learners' ability to analyse and evaluate different types of source material (both physical and documentary including the castle itself) as evidence about this history the castle.

Please note that the SAM uses Conwy Castle in North Wales as an exemplar and Conwy is NOT an OCR set site.

Please turn over for the Castles: Form and Function contents grid.

Learners should examine these points through the contexts and content set out below.

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The location of Kenilworth Castle	• The strategic location of Kenilworth Castle. • The specific geographical location of Kenilworth Castle. • The specific physical location of Kenilworth Castle. • The evidence used by historians, e.g. maps from medieval to modern times, drawings in local histories.
The appearance and layout of Kenilworth Castle at different times in its history	• Key features of the castle e.g. motte and bailey layouts, stone towers, defences, great hall, causeway. • When and why these features were installed or removed, including the slighting. • What these changes reveal about the history of the country at the time. • The evidence used by historians e.g. contracts, architect plans, contemporary drawings, aerial photographs.
Day to day function(s) of Kenilworth Castle at different times in its history	• Kenilworth Castle as means of conquest, particularly in the Norman period. • Kenilworth Castle as means of baronial and or royal power. • Kenilworth Castle as centre of administration, justice etc. • Kenilworth Castle as a dwelling place. • The evidence used by historians, e.g. royal licenses, newspaper articles.
Life in Kenilworth Castle at different times in its history	• The lives of the castle owners e.g. the De Clintons, de Montfort, Lancaster, John of Gaunt, Tudors, Dudleys, Stuarts, Hydes. • The people who made the castle function e.g. blacksmiths, cooks etc. • The evidence used by historians e.g. bills and accounts, inventories.
Key events associated with Kenilworth Castle at different times in its history	• Connections to events including: baronial and other rebellions, border warfare, civil war sieges.